

Across Borders: The Decision

跨越边界：决定

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The decision was made in a **national convention** hall, with a **speaker who** had **come to follow** the case to its end. “**Who will handle our path?**” a **peasant** from the **intensive farming** district asked. “A **sentence** in a document is not a road.” Perhaps the minister would **come**, and perhaps she would not; you could understand the room’s mood from the empty seat in front.

The **abuse** of **privilege**, the **rejection** of the **due** process, and the **hostile rally** outside were all part of the same small drama. “We may **elect** a council,” the **speaker** said, “or we may **resist** the whole **convention**.” They had to **translate** their **preference** into a policy, and the **polish** of the language did not make the choice easier.

A **sociable** ambassador, a **nationalist** with a **broad** accent, and a **container** of **harvest** samples sat in the front row. “A **privilege** is derived from a duty,” she said, “and **our** duty is to the coast.” A **kilogram** of rice, a **cushion** on the chair, and a **strap** on a suitcase: the props of a formal argument about who belongs.

The **Olympics broadcast** had been interrupted by the news; the war had killed the **broadcast** entirely. “Small children **swim** here in May,” a woman said. “Perhaps they will **swim** in September.” The **infrastructure** of the little resort had begun to **drift**, and no minister would take the **toll** on the road.

The decision, when it came, was to **originate** a service rather than inherit one, and to **worship** nothing but the timetable itself. “They will **immigrate** here for the speed,” the **speaker** said, “not for **our** sentiments.” It was late, the trains had stopped, and the work of the next year was already written on the board. The **regard** of the country had become a job in itself. “The fact is,” the **speaker** said, “that a **national** hall can hold a thousand people and still miss the small stop where you get off.” A **broad path**, a **due** process, and a **preference** for the **harvest** over the **rally**: the decision would **follow** the facts, not the crowd.

中文翻译

决定是在一座全国性的大会堂里做出的，一位发言人来此把案子追到底。“谁来管我们这条路？”一位来自集约农业区的农民问，“文件里的一句话不是一条路。”部长也许会来，也许不会；从前面那把空椅子就能读懂屋里的的情绪。

对特权的滥用、对正当程序的拒绝，以及外面那场充满敌意的集会，都属于同一出小戏。“我们可以选出一个委员会，”发言人说，“也可以抵制整个大会。”他们必须把自己的偏好翻译成政策，而语言的修饰并没有让选择更容易。

一位爱交际的大使、一位口音很宽的民族主义者，以及一箱收成样本坐在前排。“特权源自义务，”她说，“而我们的义务在海岸。”一公斤大米、椅子上的一只靠垫、行李箱上的一条带子：一场关于谁属于这里的正式论辩的道具。

奥运转播被新闻打断；战争彻底杀死了转播。“小孩子们五月在这里游泳，”一位女士说，“也许九月他们还会来。”这个小度假地的基础设施已经开始漂移，而没有哪位部长愿意承担道路的通行费。

决定最终是：开创一项服务，而不是继承一项；除了时刻表本身，不崇拜任何东西。“他们会为了速度移居到这里，”发言人说，“而不是为我们的情绪。”天已经晚了，火车停了，而下一年的工作已经写在黑板上。这个国家的关注本身已经成了一份工作。“事实是，”发言人说，“一座全国性的大厅能容纳一千人，却仍然会漏掉你下车的那个小站。”一条宽阔的路、一道正当的程序，以及对收成而非集会的偏爱：决定将跟随事实，而不是人群。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
who hu: POS: pron	pron. 谁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a United Nations agency to coordinate international health activities and to help governments improve health...
come kʌm POS: vi	vi. 过来, 来, 到达, 出现, 开始; interj. 喂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move toward, travel toward something or somebody or approach something or somebody; v. come to pass; arrive...
our 'aʊə POS: pron	pron. 我们的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pl. of I; possessive pron. Of or pertaining to us; belonging to us; as, our; country; our rights; our troop...
follow 'fɒləʊ POS: vt	vt. 跟随, 沿行, 遵循, 追求; vi. 跟随, 接着; n. 跟随, 追随 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to travel behind, go after, come after; v. come as a logical consequence; follow logically; v. travel along...
national 'næʃənəl POS: a	a. 国家的, 国立的, 全国性的, 民族的; [经] 全国性的, 国家的, 国民的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who owes allegiance to that nation; a. of or relating to or belonging to a nation or country; a. li...
kill kil POS: n	n. 杀, 杀戮, 小河; vt. 杀, 破坏, 消灭, 使终止, 抵消, 否决; vi. 杀死; [计] 删除 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the destruction of an enemy plane or ship or tank or missile; v. cause to die; put to death, usually intent...
regard ri'gɑ:d POS: n	n. 关心, 注意, 尊敬, 关系, 问候; vt. 视为, 注意, 考虑, 和...有关, 看待; vi. 注视, 注意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually plural) a polite expression of desire for someone's welfare; n. a feeling of friendship and esteem...
speaker 'spi:kə POS: n	n. 说话人, 讲演者, 发言人, 喇叭, 扬声器; [计] 扬声器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who expresses in language; someone who talks (especially someone who delivers a public speech or s...
sentence 'sentəns POS: n	n. 句子, 命题, 宣判; vt. 宣判, 判决; [计] 句子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a string of words satisfying the grammatical rules of a language; v. pronounce a sentence on (somebody) in...
handle hændl POS: n	n. 柄, 把手, 把柄, 柄状物, 手感; vt. 触摸, 运用, 买卖, 处理, 操作; vi. 搬运, 易于操纵; n. 句柄; [计] 句柄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the appendage to an object that is designed to be held in order to use or move it; v. touch, lift, or hold...
path pɑ:θ POS: n	n. 路径, 小路, 道路, 途径, 路线, 轨道; [计] 路径; DOS内部命令:设定DOS读取程序的路径 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a way especially designed for a particular use; n. an established line of travel or access; n. a line or rou...
due dju: POS: n	n. 应得的东西, 应付款; a. 到期的, 应得的, 应付的, 约定的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. that which is deserved or owed; n. a payment that is due (e.g., as the price of membership); a. owed and pay...
broad brɔ:d POS: a	a. 宽广的, 辽阔的, 广大的, 显著的; adv. 宽阔地; n. 宽阔部分 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. slang term for a woman; s. not detailed or specific; s. lacking subtlety; obvious; s. being at a peak or culm...
abuse ə'bjʊ:s.ə'bjʊ:z POS: n	n. 滥用, 虐待, 恶习, 辱骂; vt. 滥用, 辱骂, 虐待 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a rude expression intended to offend or hurt; v. use foul or abusive language towards; v. use wrongly or imp...
elect i'lekt POS: n	n. 当选人, 被选的人; a. 被选的, 选出的; vt. 选举, 选择; vi. 作选择 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. select by a vote for an office or membership; v. choose; s. selected as the best; s. elected but not yet inst...
derive di'raiv POS: vt	vt. 得自; vi. 起源 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. obtain; v. come from; v. develop or evolve from a latent or potential state; v. come from; be connected by a...
convention kən'venʃən POS: n	n. 大会, 协定, 惯例, 约定; [计] 约定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large formal assembly; n. something regarded as a normative example; n. (diplomacy) an international agree...
resist ri'zist POS: v	v. 抵抗, 耐得住, 抵制, 反抗; n. 防染材料 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. stand up or offer resistance to somebody or something; v. withstand the force of something; v. resist immuno...
peasant 'peznt POS: n	n. 农夫, 乡下人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a country person; n. one of a (chiefly European) class of agricultural laborers; n. a crude uncouth ill-bred...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
preference 'prefərəns POS: n	n. 偏爱, 优先, 喜爱物; [计] 首选项 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong liking; n. the right or chance to choose; n. grant of favor or advantage to one over another (espec...
translate træns'leɪt POS: vt	vt. 翻译, 解释, 转化, 转变为, 调动; vi. 翻译, 被译; [计] 转换 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. restate (words) from one language into another language; v. change from one form or medium into another; v. ...
swim swɪm POS: n	n. 游泳, 漂浮, 潮流, 眩晕; vi. 游泳, 游, 漂浮, 浸, 覆盖, 充溢, 大量拥有, 旋转, 眩晕; vt. 游过, 使浮起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. travel through water; v. be dizzy or giddy; v. be covered with or submerged in a liquid; v. move as if glidin...
privilege 'prɪvɪlɪdʒ POS: n	n. 特权, 特别恩典, 基本权利, 特免; vt. 给与...特权, 特免 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a special advantage or immunity or benefit not enjoyed by all; n. (law) the right to refuse to divulge info...
farming 'fɑ:mɪŋ POS: n	n. 农业, 耕作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the practice of cultivating the land or raising stock; n. agriculture considered as an occupation or way of...
container kən'teɪnə POS: n	n. 容器, 集装箱; [化] 集装箱; 贮存箱; 容器(任何一种) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any object that can be used to hold things (especially a large metal boxlike object of standardized dimens...
drift drɪft POS: n	n. 漂流物, 漂流, 动向; v. (使)漂流 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a force that moves something along; n. the gradual departure from an intended course due to external influe...
infrastructure 'ɪnfrestrʌktʃə POS: n	n. 基础结构, 基础设施; [经] 基础设施 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the basic structure or features of a system or organization; n. the stock of basic facilities and capital e...
broadcast 'brɔ:dkæst POS: n	n. 广播, 传播; a. 广播的; v. 广播; adv. 经广播, 四散地; [计] 广播命令, 广播 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. message that is transmitted by radio or television; n. a radio or television show; v. sow over a wide area, ...
Olympics əʊ'lɪmpɪks POS: n	n. 奥林匹克运动会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the modern revival of the ancient games held once every 4 years in a selected country
intensive ɪn'tensɪv POS: a	a. 加强的, 内涵的, 集中的; n. 加强器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by a high degree or intensity; often used as a combining form; a. tending to give force or em...
hostile 'hɒstail POS: a	a. 敌人的, 怀敌意的, 敌对的; n. 敌对分子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. troops belonging to the enemy's military forces; a. characterized by enmity or ill will; a. not belonging to...
rally 'ræli POS: n	n. 重振旗鼓, 集合, 群众集会, 跌停回升; v. 重整旗鼓, 集合, 恢复精神, 团结, 挖苦, 嘲笑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large gathering of people intended to arouse enthusiasm; n. the feat of mustering strength for a renewed...
rejection rɪ'dʒekʃən POS: n	n. 拒绝, 抛弃, 驳回, 被抛弃的东西, 呕出物; [化] 报废; 拒收 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of rejecting something; n. the state of being rejected; n. (medicine) an immunological response that...
polish 'pɒlɪʃ POS: a	a. 波兰的; n. 波兰人, 上光剂, 光泽, 优雅; vt. 擦亮, 擦去, 使完美; vi. 擦亮, 变得光亮 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property of being smooth and shiny; n. a highly developed state of perfection; having a flawless or imp...
originate ə'ɪdʒɪneɪt POS: vt	vt. 创始, 发明, 发起; vi. 发源, 发生, 起航; [计] 发自 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. come into existence; take on form or shape; v. bring into being; v. begin a trip at a certain point, as of a...
worship 'wɔ:ʃɪp POS: n	n. 崇拜, 礼拜, 尊敬; vi. 参加礼拜; vt. 崇拜, 尊敬 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of worshipping; n. a feeling of profound love and admiration; v. show devotion to (a deity); v. ...
toll təʊl POS: n	n. 通行费, 代价, 钟声; vt. 征收, 敲钟, 鸣钟, 勾引, 引诱; vi. 征税, 鸣钟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fee levied for the use of roads or bridges (used for maintenance); v. ring slowly; v. charge a fee for usi...
harvest 'hɑ:vɪst POS: n	n. 收获, 成果, 收获物, 收获期; v. 收割, 收获 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the consequence of an effort or activity; n. the gathering of a ripened crop; n. the season for gathering cr...
nationalist 'næʃənəlɪst POS: n	n. 国家主义者, 民族主义者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an advocate of national independence of or a strong national government; s. devotion to the interests or cu...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
strap stræp POS: n	n. 带, 皮带; vt. (用皮带)捆扎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an elongated leather strip (or a strip of similar material) for binding things together or holding somethi...
cushion 'kʊʃən POS: n	n. 垫子, 橡皮软垫; vt. 加垫褥, 缓冲, 掩盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the layer of air that supports a hovercraft or similar vehicle; n. a soft bag filled with air or a mass of...
immigrate 'imigreɪt POS: vt	vt. 使移居入境; vi. 移入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. migrate to a new environment; v. introduce or send as immigrants; v. come into a new country and change resi...
sociable 'səʊjəbl POS: a	a. 好交际的, 社交的, 过社会生活的; n. 联谊会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a party of people assembled to promote sociability and communal activity; a. inclined to or conducive to co...
kilogram 'kɪləgræm POS: n	n. 千克, 公斤; [医] 千克, 公斤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one thousand grams; the basic unit of mass adopted under the Systeme International d'Unites
speeding 'spi:diŋ POS: n	n. 超速行驶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n changing location rapidly; v move fast; v move faster; v move very fast; v travel at an excessive or illegal ve...